

ADVERTISEMENT

02-05-2021 | CAREER EVOLUTION

## 6 career coaches share the best career advice they ever got

When it comes to career advice, these coaches have heard it all. Here, they share the best advice they ever received.

SHARE

ADD ON GOOGLE



[Source photo: primipil/iStock]



BY GWEN MORAN

When it comes to evaluating career advice, few people are in a position to hear so much of it—and evaluate how it works out for the practitioners—than career coaches. Since they help their clients pore over strategies to advance their careers and look for their next jobs, they’re front and center when it comes to what works and what doesn’t.

Here, six career coaches share the best advice they ever got and how it helped them move forward in their own careers:

### LET THEM TELL YOU “NO”

Too often, fear, **impostor syndrome**, or other challenges lead us to talk ourselves out of opportunities before we even have a shot at them. A better way: “Let *them* tell you ‘no,’” says Angelina Darrisaw, founder and CEO of C-Suite Coach, a firm that sources and trains coaches. “Getting a ‘yes to every promotion, raise, etc. is not likely, but a ‘no’ is certain if we don’t pursue it at all.”

Instead, embrace the risk it takes to pursue your goals or take a shot at something new, she says. Even if it doesn’t work out, you could get yourself noticed and open doors for future opportunities that may be a better fit. “Asking for things we feel unqualified or unprepared for is understandably risky and scary, but if we tell ourselves no, we will never get to hear a yes,” she says.



**Subscribe to the Daily newsletter.** Fast Company's trending stories delivered to you every day

Email \*

SIGN UP

[Privacy Policy](#) | [Fast Company Newsletters](#)

**YOU'RE HUMAN: ACT LIKE IT**

ADVERTISEMENT

### FEATURED VIDEO

Vic Mensa on the business of...



**Vic Mensa on the business of creativity**

ADVERTISEMENT

Early in her career, a manager had some advice for Jackie Mitchell: “You coworkers will relate to you and respect you more when you don’t hold your personality back.” Mitchell, now an executive career coach, says that sometimes we’re so buttoned-up and ‘professional’ that we “forget to have personality in our interactions with others.” Once Mitchell let more of herself shine through in her job and let herself show **vulnerability**, she found her relationships deepened and she expanded her circle of influence, she says.

Being vulnerable also nixes perfectionism, which undermines so many in the workplace, she says. Once, when she had to facilitate a tense meeting about project funding and budgets, her “nerves took over,” she says. “So, what did I do? I said, ‘Sorry, but this is an intimidating topic, especially since we’re over budget and I need to ask you for more funding.’ One of the executives said, ‘Don’t worry, we’re all nervous.’ This broke the ice, and we were all a bit more relaxed after that. And yes, I got the additional funding I needed for my project.” Being “human” on the job can make us more relatable, approachable, and successful.

### BE A “GOOD LEAVER”

Sometimes, a role or manager creates a situation that’s untenable, and it’s time to move on. As tempting as it may be to set the bridge ablaze as you walk out the door, it’s almost never a good idea, says career coach Kay White, author of *The A to Z of Being Understood: Make Your Voice Heard and Your Conversations Count*. “‘The person you throw under the bus today could be driving it tomorrow.’ That quote from Glenn Shepard encapsulates the best career advice I’ve ever received,” she says.

EXPAND TO CONTINUE READING ↓

#### EXPLORE TOPICS

- CAREER ADVICE
- CAREER COACH
- CAREER EVOLUTION
- CONFIDENCE
- IMPOSTER SYNDROME
- INTERVIEW SKILLS